NCCA ENTERTAINMENT | STUDIO ONE PAGER

The Terms of Engagement

A political romantic comedy | Original feature | Target: Netflix

LOGLINE

When a hot mic catches two rival political strategists trashing their own candidates, their bosses rebrand the scandal as a secret romance and stage an engagement through Election Day. As a signed contract threatens to leak, the relationship they are faking becomes the only honest thing either of them has done in a decade.

THE STORY

Alex Chase is a Democratic strategist from a Dayton union family who writes the promises she stopped believing. Marcus Thorne is a Republican strategist and the son of a Georgia senator who taught him one rule: never pause. After eleven years as rivals, a leaked green room recording costs them both their jobs. Their bosses see a lifeline in a focus group dial test and sell America a secret couple.

Alex writes the terms herself. Public appearances only. No kissing on the mouth. Term ends election night. No falling in love. Then come the morning shows, a Georgetown dinner that turns into a chess match, chili in Dayton, and a fight over the jobs bill that charm cannot settle. When Alex loses her grandmother and Marcus walks out of a three million dollar fundraiser to stand beside her in the receiving line, the contract tears. Days later it is front page news.

Both are offered a way back if they betray the other. Alex tells the truth first, on the record, without knowing what Marcus will do. On live television, Marcus takes the pause he was trained never to take, owns the lie, refuses to blame her, and walks away from his father's Senate seat. They end on the steps of the Lincoln Memorial at dawn, still disagreeing, finally honest.

WHY NETFLIX, WHY NOW

A proven lane. High concept political romance travels, and every territory knows the gap between public performance and private truth.

Black excellence at the center. Two Black political professionals, a union family in Ohio, and a Georgia political dynasty. Specific, lived in, and new to the genre.

Romance with consequences. The leads choose each other only after each tells a costly public truth. The ending earns its sunrise.

Built for clips. The hot mic, the contract signing, the dinner table checkmate, and a silent pause on live television that becomes the awards scene.

FORMAT

Original feature film. Fourth Draft, approx. 96 pages.

GENRE

Political romantic comedy with satirical bite and real emotional stakes.

PLATFORM

Netflix. Global hook, four-quadrant romance, prestige satire.

BUDGET TIER

$30M to $55M. Two leads, contained locations, dialogue driven.

LOCATIONS

Washington, D.C. | Dayton, Ohio | Atlanta, Georgia

TONE COMPS

Long Shot meets *Red, White & Royal Blue*, with the romantic register of *Insecure* and the teeth of *Veep*.

DREAM PAIRING

Ayo Edebiri as Alex Chase.
Regé-Jean Page as Marcus Thorne.
See cast suggestions.

SIGNATURE IMAGES

A handwritten contract. A union pin on loan. A cufflink tell. A fake painted sky, and a real sunrise.

Written by Kelly R. Tenney

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